

Abhishek Rathod

Industrial Designer | Hardware Product design | Soft-goods

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Summary

Industrial designer with a Mechanical Engineering foundation – bridging human-centered design with engineering feasibility. Experienced in end-to-end product development from research and ideation through CAD, prototyping, and manufacturing-ready deliverables.

Education

M.S. In Industrial Design

Human-Centered Design

Thomas Jefferson University

2024-2026

Mechanical Engineering

A. D. Patel Institute of Technology

2019-2023

Design skills

Research & Strategy

- User research • Market analysis
- Ergonomics • Concept development

Design & Prototyping

- Sketching • Ideation
- Rapid prototyping • Model making
- Softgoods design • DFM

Fabrication

- Laser cutting • 3D printing • CNC
- Sewing/softgoods

Software skills

3D & CAD

- Solidworks • Fusion 360 • Rhino

Rendering

- Blender • KeyShot

Adobe Suite

- Illustrator • Photoshop • Indesign
- Premiere pro • Fresco • After Effects

Fabrication

- Creality Print • Sketchbook
- Arduino IDE

Work experience

Fabrication lab supervisor & Design mentor

Thomas Jefferson University - 2024 to 2026

- Managed fabrication lab operations – laser cutters, 3D printers, and CNC – across industrial and product design programs.
- Mentored 50+ students per semester through prototyping sprints and design critique.
- Engineered a wire-frame wing structure for bodice integration and a coordinating 3D-printed accessory for a fashion design student.

Junior CAD Designer

iMAC Design and Engineering Services - 2023 to 2024

- Led design of the Pillbox medication reminder device – user research, 3 sketch iterations, and production-ready SolidWorks CAD with audio alert integration.
- Produced CAD models and assembly drawings within client tolerancing and manufacturing specs.
- Flagged fit and clearance issues in design reviews, reducing revision cycles before prototype release.

Freelance CAD Designer

PlastoKraft Inc. - 2023

- Modeled gift articles in CAD from client-provided references for injection molding production.
- Produced photorealistic KeyShot renders for client approval and presentation.

Institute Sponsored Project

Streamlight, Sprint 2024 | 10days

- Designed a compact, foldable under-hood light for easy trunk/glovebox storage
- Engineered collapsible segments for 180 cm extension, fit for cars to heavy trucks
- Built and demonstrated a working prototype to the institute panel

WD-40, Sprint 2026 | 10 days

- Designed an interactive flip-panel display pairing each specialty product with its use case
- Built a companion app beyond scope, recommending specialties from user inputs
- Presented to WD-40; earned special recognition for exceeding deliverables

Recognition

Child Mobility Device – Easter Seals Collaboration

- Designed a custom mobility aid for children with physical disabilities in partnership with Easter Seals
- Applied human-centered design methods, including caregiver interviews, ergonomic analysis, and iterative prototyping
- Featured by Thomas Jefferson University and Philadelphia media; device remains in active use today